

Japan Winter Budget Adventure

7-Day Itinerary | Winter | Budget Backpacker | Tokyo - Kyoto - Osaka

Day	Place	Plan & Food
1	Tokyo - Shinjuku	Arrive in Tokyo and check into a budget hostel. Explore Shinjuku, visit the free Tokyo Metropolitan Government Building observation deck, and walk through the neon streets. Dinner: affordable ramen.
2	Tokyo	Visit Meiji Shrine, Harajuku and Shibuya Crossing. Browse local shops and neighbourhood streets. Lunch: a cheap rice bowl or convenience-store meal. Dinner: Japanese yakiniku BBQ.
3	Tokyo	Explore Asakusa and Senso-ji, then Ueno and Ameyoko. Try inexpensive street food such as yakitori and other local snacks.
4	Tokyo -> Kyoto	Take a highway or overnight bus to keep long-distance transport affordable. Check into a Kyoto hostel and explore Gion and the streets around Yasaka Shrine. Dinner: udon or Japanese curry.
5	Kyoto	Visit Fushimi Inari early, then explore the Kiyomizu-dera area and traditional streets. Choose an inexpensive local set meal for lunch.
6	Kyoto -> Osaka	Take a local train to Osaka. Explore Dotonbori and Shinsekai. Try takoyaki, okonomiyaki and another affordable Japanese BBQ meal. Stay in a budget hostel.
7	Osaka	Walk around Osaka Castle Park and visit Kuromon Market. Enjoy a final inexpensive Japanese meal before travelling home.

Budget Tips

Stay in hostels, use local trains and buses where practical, and mix restaurant meals with supermarkets and convenience stores. For Tokyo-Kyoto, compare highway/overnight buses with rail prices before booking. A practical target is about **JPY 7,000-12,000 per day** for basic accommodation, local transport and food, excluding flights and major long-distance transport.

Money & Safety

Carry only the cash needed for the day. Keep your wallet, passport and phone in a zipped inner pocket or secure bag, especially in crowded stations and nightlife areas. Use hostel lockers for valuables and keep a backup bank card separate from your main wallet. Save digital copies of important travel documents.

Why This Trip Fits the Traveller

The plan includes Shinjuku, Japanese food and BBQ while keeping the trip suitable for a budget backpacker. It combines major city experiences with mostly free or low-cost sightseeing and affordable transport choices.